Widget Server 4.2 Release Notes

Document Number GC00-4200

November 6th, 2026

The Widget Team

customer

Abstract

This document describes Widget Server Version 4.2, which runs on z/OS, z/VM, Linux on Z.

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Overview

Widget Server 4.2 is a maintenance release. It contains the changes listed in “Changes in 4.2” on page 2.

Contact your sales representative for the support schedule.

Changes in 4.2

The following changes were made:

1. Faster start-up
2. New “quiet” start option
3. Fixes for the problems listed in Figure 1

This release has 3 changes (see footnote [1]).

> Important: Back up the configuration before you upgrade.

Configuration

The configuration file now accepts these keywords:

timeout Seconds to wait for a client (default 30).

quiet Suppresses the start-up banner.

An example:

```
server  main
  timeout 45
  quiet
```

- WS0012: crash on empty request
- WS0019: wrong date in log

Figure 1. Problems fixed in 4.2

[1] Measured on a cold system.

Capacity planning

Each worker thread of Widget Server 4.2 serves about r = 250 requests per second, so a server with w = 8 workers handles at most

$$T = w \cdot r = 8 \cdot 250 = 2000 \tag{1}$$

requests per second, or 172800000 requests a day.

At start-up the 12 cache shards are warmed one after another, and shard k takes k seconds, so the warm-up takes

$$\sum_{k=1}^{12} k = \frac{12(12+1)}{2} = 78 \text{ s} \tag{2}$$

before the server accepts requests.

Plan the offered load λ so that the utilisation ρ stays at or below 0.8. With λ = 1600 requests per second and T from (1),

$$\rho = \frac{\lambda}{T} = \frac{1600}{2000} = 0.80 \le 0.8 \tag{3}$$

If ρ in (3) rises above the limit, add workers: by (1) each one adds 250 requests per second.

Platforms

Supported platforms:

- z/OS
- z/VM
- Linux on Z

Note: All platforms need the latest service level.

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